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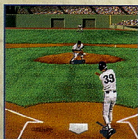
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TOP

1 Phantasmagoria

Golden Triad Award
—Computer Gaming World

"Breakthrough Game of 1995"
—PC Entertainment Editor's Choice



2 FPS: Baseball Pro '96

"With its statistics, graphics, playability and sound Baseball Pro '96 is the total baseball experience — minus the traffic, lack of parking space and hot dog vendors."
—Newsday

"Sierra definitely has a winner here."
—Computer Sports Edge



3 NASCAR

Premier Simulation Game of 1995
—Computer Gaming World

Codie Award for Best Sports Program of 1995
—Software Publishers Association



6 Silent Thunder A-10 Tank Killer II

"...a fresh title that's sure to please fans of the original game."
—PC Games



7 Gabriel Knight: The Beast Within

Game of the Year 1996
—Computer Gaming World

"A strong case for interactive movies"
—CD-ROM Today



8 Police Quest: SWAT

"...a pulse pounding glimpse into the lives of America's most elite law enforcement officers..."
—PC Gamer

"This is the perfect game for anyone with a serious interest in the workings of a SWAT unit."
—Home Computing & Entertainment



1 Print Artist 3.0

"A wealth of features to turn any family computer into an instant print shop."
—Family PC



2 Hoyle Classic Games

"Sierra's Hoyle series features the most entertaining PC card play on the market."
—PC Magazine



3 LandDesigner

"Simple enough for a beginner to use and it offers enough information about gardening to accommodate the needs of even an experienced plant person."
—Family PC



6 The Incredible Machine 3.0

Seal of Approval
—National Parenting Center

Puzzle Game of the Year
—Family PC



7 The Lost Mind of Dr. Brain

Codie Award for Best Home Learning Product
—Software Publishers Association

Highest overall rating for children's software
—Consumer Reports Magazine



8 Mixed-Up Mother Goose Deluxe

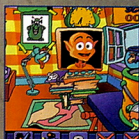
Parents Choice Award
—Parents' Choice Foundation

Best Early Education Program
—Software Publishers Association



<http://www.sierra.com>

TEN



4 Missionforce: CyberStorm

"A tasty blend of strategy, role-playing, arcade and miniature board gaming."
—Computer Gaming World

"Missionforce's scrupulous attention to detail is exceeded only by its incredible game play."
—PC Games



5 3-D Ultra Pinball

"They have finally succeeded in bringing pinball to the PC hot dog!"
—CD-ROM Advisor

IndyCar Racing II

"For racing verite, Papyrus Design Group's frighteningly authentic IndyCar Racing II is the champion."
—Computer Life

"Sparkling, sharp, clear—pick a superlative and it applies to everything on and off the track."
—Computer Gaming World



9 FPS: Trophy Bass

"It absolutely hooked the fishermen of all ages that own a computer."
—Computer Games Strategy Plus



10 Shivers

"★★★★"
—Home PC

"Breathtaking graphics and storyline create a top notch CD-ROM thriller."
—PC Gamer



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1 The Even More Incredible Machine



2 Red Baron with A-10 Tank Killer



3 Gabriel Knight: Sins of the Father



4 King's Quest VI



5 Caesar I



6 The Island of Dr. Brain



7 Leisure Suit Larry I



8 Incredible Toon Machine



9 Land Designer 2.0



10 Hoyle Classic Board Games



4 MasterCook Deluxe

"Best Software for Cooks"
—Bon Appetit

"★★★★"
—Family Computing



5 MasterCook: CookingLight

"If you need to plan meals according to good nutrition, and you're looking for a nifty recipe organizer, CookingLight will keep you healthy and well-fed for a long time."
—Computer Shopper



9 Adi English 4-5

"★★★★½: Our testers loved the program... There's so much to do."
—Warren Buckleitner
Children's Software Review



10 Playtoons: Uncle Archibald

"In all, this title packs plenty of creativity power, and is one of just a few titles with the ability to narrate the action with the children's own voices."
—Children's Software Review

"Kids need to stimulate their imagination, and Playtoons does that. These disks deliver on the promise of the 'active' in 'interactive.'"
—CD-ROM Today



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Reach Out and

Hot Tips for Head-to-Head Battling in the EarthSiege Universe with

yours won't adversely affect the game speed, so you can play against all your buddies with 14.4K and 28.8K modems. Likewise, two computers of varying speeds won't pose any problems with game play.

Network Free-For-Alls

The office has long been the 5:00 p.m. battleground for networked gamers. *CyberStorm* offers the excitement of HERC combat in rapid action battles that make first-person shoot 'em ups seem tame. Network games can be conducted in three ways:

- Teams of players against each other (with or without Cybrids as an added element).
- A Free-for-all with each player battling it out until only one is left standing (again, with or without Cybrids as an added element).
- Humans vs. Cybrids with the Cybrid Force Level maxed to emulate an Elite Military Mission.

Modem Battling Head-to-Head

Because modems must connect one-to-one directly, modem games can only be two-player, though Cybrids may be present if desired. Modem play is head-to-head. For modem play, you need a minimum of a 14.4K baud modem or better, or a "null" modem connection (if players are in the same physical location). Two players with varying modem speeds will not adversely affect the play balance.

by John Sauer, author of the Official
Missionforce: CyberStorm Strategy Guide



If you think *Missionforce: CyberStorm* is fun against Cybrids, wait until you try it against a living enemy. *CyberStorm* in multi-player mode takes on whole new dimensions in fun and challenge as you play against opponents who are much more ingenious and unpredictable than any computer-generated enemy. Best of all, reaching out to crush someone is not hard to do. The game comes with a free Buddy Disc included—a complete, second copy of the game—two games for the price of one! Sierra wants you

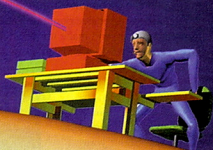
to give this game to a friend so you two can hook up and experience what so many gamers are raving about, the hottest multi-player modem and network gaming around.

Missionforce: CyberStorm may be played on PCs with up to eight people on a local area network (LAN, such as is found in most offices) or with two players head-to-head via modem. Requirements for network play are an IPX network with all players on the same network hub or node. Playing against someone with a different modem speed than

Crush Someone

M i s s i o n f o r c e

CyberStorm



"I am extremely pleased that you decided to ship two CDs with the game. Games are always enjoyed more when playing against someone else." —Michael Triplett

SierraWeb: THE Place to Find New Opponents

If you don't have a ready friend to dial up, you can find willing opponents on the SierraWeb. So many gamers spend time cruising cyberspace that Sierra has added chat rooms where you can interact with others who are playing your favorite Sierra games. Check out the new *Missionforce: CyberStorm* Chat Room at www.sierra.com/cyberstorm/chat.html to set up matches for head-to-head games and talk with other *Cyberstorm* players. Once you've arranged the details of the game and traded phone numbers, you log off your Internet connection and dial your opponent directly! You'll also be able to download the Sierra-sanctioned *Missionforce: Cyberstorm* tournament guidelines in case you want to host a single game or battle royale that offers the fairest balance of strategy and HERC power.

If you don't have Internet access yet (and you should, 'cause Sierra will be releasing a lot of games that you can actually play over the SierraWeb), you

can also find players by checking out the challenge rooms or leaving messages on the Sierra forums on America OnLine and CompuServe.

Don't forget to scan the uploads to find HERC configurations that gamers have created and posted, or take your



If you end a turn sitting high and you become a sitting duck, save enough power to get down before your turn ends.

favorite HERC and submit it for other gamers to use. Sierra will be posting tons of new HERC configs as well. Don't be surprised if you hook up with a player for a modem game and they use your HERC config back against you!

Multi-Player Basics

All multi-player games have a Force Value and a Rank Level determined by the creator. The Force Value is the maximum credit value of all HERCs, weapons, devices, and Bionomers in your individual fleet. The Rank Level

is similar to the Tech Level in single-player mode. When you load a group, if it exceeds the Force Value or Rank Level that was set by the creator, you will be unable to play in that game.

Likewise, if the creator has set a Rank Level of 7 and you have any technology that was acquired at a higher Tech Level, you must remove that technology from any HERC configuration before your group will be "legal."

Like single-player games, multi-player sessions are turn-based. A timer in the upper right corner of the

screen shows you how much time players have left for their turn. When the timer reaches the 15-second mark, it flashes red and white as a warning.

All player vehicles appear on the battlefield in the specified color. You see

"This is by far the best game I have played in a long time. honest opinion, this game rates six stars out of five."

all players on both the mini-map and in the main view as long as they are within reach of your sensors (which is why strong scouts are such a good idea). All players start at opposing points of the battlefield.

Since your moves are timed, you must complete your firing paths and movements before time is up. In between turns you can reconnoiter through the mini-map, send/receive communications, pre-plan moves, and make minor adjustments to your HERCs and Bioderms.

Making Conversation

Players may send messages (such as taunts or general comments about your opponent's inability to control HERCs) at any time by pressing the [Enter] key and typing away. The Message Dialog Screen will also display all messages from other players who have you in their communication loop. To remove the dialog box, press ESC. If you are eliminated from the game, you may only view the continuing battle and send/receive messages, giving you the ability to cry from the sidelines.

Multi-Player Tactics That Give You An Edge

Because there are so many variables involved in setting up a multi-player game, there is no "one best configuration" to take into battle. In general, you should get the maximum number and most expensive HERCs and 'Derms you can afford in the Rank Level

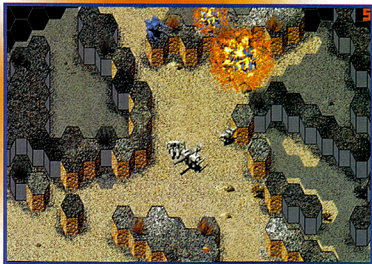
and Force Value of the match you are about to enter. Balance is the key. But there are things you can do to increase your chances of feeling the thrill of victory instead of the agony of defeat.

Depending on which planet you battle on, some weapons or systems may be inoperative. If you have studied the planets and know how the electromagnetic fields and other features of a planet will affect combat, you can tailor your HERCs for that particular world. If, for example, you battle on a planet that renders shields more or less inoperative,

out and see where your opponents are. If you don't, you're a sitting duck until they find you, or you just happen to run into them.

Smart Weapon Choices

When choosing between weapons that fire several times and weapons that fire once (both doing relative amounts of damage) choose the single fire weapons. Often you will not have enough time to fire all your weapons if you have to manually fire them three or four times in the turn (unless you use the Shift A command). Don't bring specialized weapons. It is far better to bring general-purpose, high-impact weapons and fire everything off in one glorious burst (using Shift A) and move on to your next pilot. Weapons that go THROUGH armor (like ELF's and Thermal Needlers) are especially useful in multi-player mode. Most people will cluster their HERCs together, so having weapons that take advantage of this behavior with a large damage radius can be a real advantage. Some of the best are the ELF Mortar, Fusion Mortar, 280mm ATX, Rapid Sat Missiles, and HOG missiles.



Survive this heat and you can do a lot of damage in return. Try to drop the shields and pound on the Reaper Class HERC first.

buy your HERCs the strongest armor you can afford and arm them with weapons that are designed to punch through armor. If your opponent(s) are equipped with shields and energy weapons, you gain enough of an advantage to massacre them in short order.

If you're going in with large HERCs that are loaded down with big weapons and heavy-duty armor, take a few smaller ones that can move quickly.

Example: If you have several Juggernauts, you're going to want a couple of scout ships so you can go

Concentrate Your Firepower

In the heat of battle, don't spread yourself too thin or divide your HERC force. A lone HERC can be a sitting duck—which in multi-player game lingo means a dead duck. The more you stay together and concentrate your firepower, the better off you'll be.

When possible, put your larger HERCs up front to break down shields, use area-affect weapons, etc., then have the smaller, faster guys move in to finish the job. Just make sure they have enough energy to get out of range before your opponent's next round, or they'll be pummeled.

Pre-Planning Moves

Don't waste your fight time deciding what to do. If you really want to put the hurt on your opponents, get some practice at mass movements. Take advantage of the time between your turns to pre-plan movement routes, then when your turn comes

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INTERACTION MAGAZINE FALL 1996

I just wish all games could be so much fun to play. In my Good work, Sierra." —From: **Freddric, Posted on: America Online**

up, use 'shift-space bar' to move all of your HERCs to the spots you selected for them. The timer's ticking so make attack and defense decisions when it is not your turn. This will avoid confusion later so that you can make the most out of your turn.

Let Them Come to You

Once you do find out where your opponents are, hang back for a while. Don't go looking for a fight. The longer you stay out of the fray, the fewer you'll have to go up against as the others will pick each other off before finding you. Find a good hiding place and stay there, then send your scouts out to see what's up.

Bloderm Considerations

If you have limited money for purchasing your Bioderms, buy Ma-Yuan. If you can't afford the better models (Tola,

Kaesar, Maia) or if you don't have the funds for training, Ma-Yuan is the best bet because you can use Jack-up on her more often than the others, increasing

such as Crow for much less, saving your money for hardware.

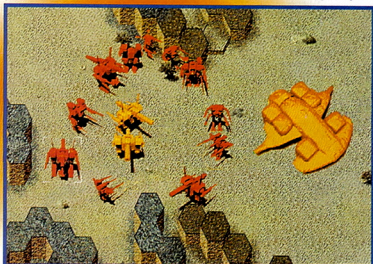
Don't Bunch Up

Space your forces out so that area effect weapon damage is limited. If you run your forces closely together, then it makes a perfect target for those multi-hex damage weapons.

Time to Play

Time, not a hostile HERC, is the biggest enemy in multi-player mode. Games are frequently won by the player who completes the most actions, not the one with the largest force.

If you haven't played *Missionforce: Cyberstorm*, you are missing out on one of the greatest experiences in gaming today, be it for one player or many. When it comes to squad-level combat, *Cyber Storm* is the ultimate game.



A lone HERC is a dead HERC. Send scouts out alone, but keep the main body of your force together for safety in numbers.

her skills. If you choose Bioderms with high Command skills, remember the cost! You can get strong, stable 'Dermis

one player or many. When it comes to squad-level combat, *Cyber Storm* is the ultimate game.

EARTHSIEGE 2

Delivers Pulse-Pounding Excitement

"From the sound of each massive Herculean footstep, to the eerie sound of the cybrids, everything is well done and feeds every monumental moment of action."

—Strategy Plus Magazine

If you get psyched pumped up thinking about controlling squads of laser-charged HERCs across battlefields on distant planets, imagine yourself in the cockpit of a 30-meter tall HERC of your very own, making the ground shake as you walk, unleashing a devastating torrent of energy and projectile weapons at all who stand in your way. This is *EarthSiege 2*. The action of this first-person smash hit was so phenomenal that the press and public alike raved about its realism and pulse-pounding excitement. The game play was faster—the terrain, enemy Cybrids, and mode of combat more realistic—than any other robot combat game.

If first-person, high-intensity, hard-core robotic battling makes your fingers twitch in anticipation, set yourself loose on *EarthSiege 2*. It just doesn't get any better than this.

